

YILAN ANNIE GAO

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- **Strategic Operations Leader:** 12+ years of experience driving cross-functional programs from concept to scaled execution within global marketplace ecosystems (Roblox, Roblox China).
- **Business Scaling Expert:** Proven track record of leading end-to-end GTM strategies for international platform launches and scaling creator/partner programs with 100% renewal rates.
- **Data-Driven Decision Maker:** Expert at synthesizing complex operational data into executive narratives that influence VP and C-suite investment and resource allocation.
- **Cross-Functional Influencer:** Adept at aligning Engineering, Policy, Legal, and Finance teams to resolve high-stakes operational blockers and drive marketplace integrity.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SENIOR PROGRAM MANAGER, Strategic Operation & Developer Relations

Roblox | Feb 2023 – Present

Strategic Business Operations & Marketplace Growth (2025–Present)

- **Marketplace Supply Lead:** Serve as the primary cross-functional lead for Roblox's top creator accounts, managing supply-side health and driving alignment across Engineering, Policy, Legal, and Moderation.
- **Global Policy Implementation:** Translate rapidly shifting regulatory mandates (AI compliance, safety) into actionable GTM guidance, ensuring platform-wide compliance while maintaining creator DAU and engagement.
- **Process Innovation:** Built a first-of-its-kind "false-moderation" protection system, defining escalation paths and communication protocols that reduced wrongful takedowns and protected platform revenue.
- **Product Rollout:** Drove the GTM strategy for an IP protection product, onboarding the platform's top developer teams through phased launches and feedback-driven iterations.

LiveOps – High-Stakes Event Operations (2024)

- **Scalable Program Execution:** Managed the full lifecycle of 5 platform-wide live events (10M+ users each), overseeing vendor contracts, work-back schedules, and real-time risk mitigation.
- **Analytical Reporting:** Translated post-event analytics into strategic recommendations for senior leadership, framing trade-offs for future engagement and content strategies.

International Expansion & Creator Operations (2023)

- **Localized Growth Strategy:** Supported UGC developer communities across China, Japan, and Latin America with tailored onboarding, partner communications, and localized engagement strategies.

- **Product Feedback Framework:** Co-designed a structured developer feedback system with the PMM team, embedding international developer insights into the global product development cycle upstream.

SENIOR PROGRAM MANAGER, Developer Relations Roblox China | Mar 2021 – Feb 2023

- **GTM & Market Entry:** Orchestrated the end-to-end platform launch in China; defined the operational model and reporting frameworks to track supply-side growth and regulatory compliance.
- **Financial Operations:** Led complex negotiations with the US Finance team to establish a cross-border data access and financial reporting framework, aligning global business strategy with local regulatory requirements.
- **Executive Advisory:** Delivered high-stakes briefings to the President of Roblox China and Global HQ, utilizing market performance data to influence multimillion-dollar resource allocations.

PARTNERSHIP PROGRAMS LEAD California State University, San Bernardino | Apr 2019 – Apr 2021

- **Portfolio Management:** Managed a \$4M+ partnership portfolio, achieving 60% recruitment growth and a 100% program renewal rate through data-informed relationship management.

CHINA PROGRAMS Manager Virginia Commonwealth University | Jul 2014 – Mar 2019

- **Market Expansion:** Led international recruitment strategy, achieving 300% enrollment growth and expanding the university's partnership footprint in the China market.
- **Program Management:** Developed and managed 5 signature international education programs, serving as the primary liaison across 10+ campus departments and 20+ global partner institutions.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Master of Product Innovation** (2018) | Virginia Commonwealth University
- **Master of Education – Adult Learning & HRD** (2014) | Virginia Commonwealth University
- **Bachelor of Arts – English & International Relations** (2012) | Sichuan International Studies University
- **Certifications:** Project Management Professional (PMP), Certified Scrum Master (CSM)
- **Technical Skills:** AI Workflow Automation (Gemini, ChatGPT, Claude), Excel, Jira, Confluence, Data Visualization, Google Suite.